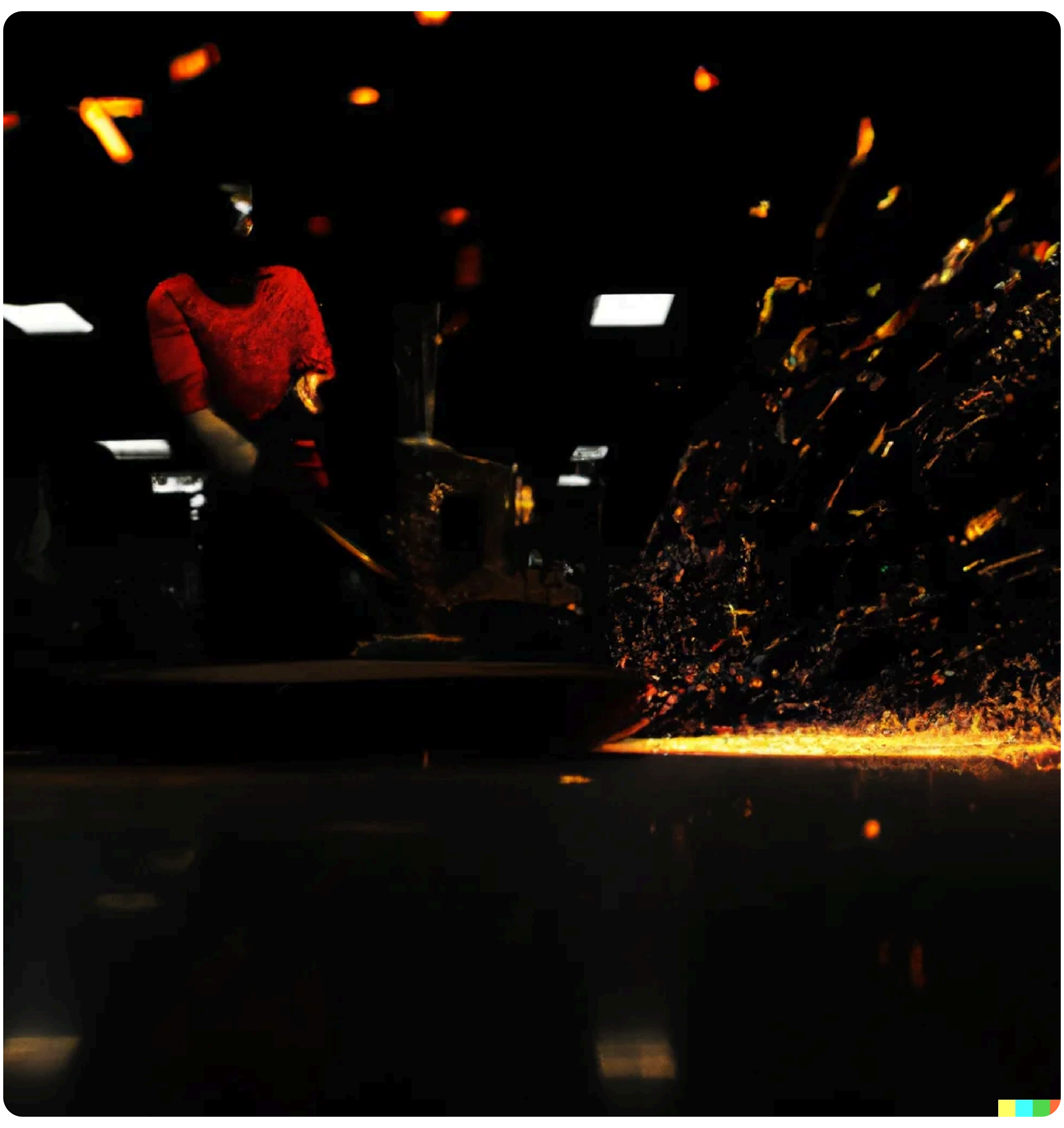
May 3, 2023

ARE YOUR WEDGES FORGED?

Pick up a wedge and you're making a choice most golfers never get explained: forged or cast. It changes how the club feels, and it changes what you pay.



Casting is the quick way, and there's nothing sinister about it. Molten steel goes into a mold, cools and comes out as a head that needs very little finishing. It's fast, it's repeatable, and it's how most of the wedges on a pro shop wall get made.

Forging starts with a solid billet of steel and presses it into shape. It takes longer, it wastes more material, and somebody has to finish the head by hand afterward. What you get for the trouble is a tighter grain in the metal, and that's why a forged wedge feels the way it does at impact: softer, with a lot more coming back up the shaft about where you caught it.

> **A cast wedge tells you the ball's gone. A forged one tells you how.**

DOES IT ACTUALLY MATTER TO YOUR SCORE?

Not much, on a full swing. Hit a stock 56 from a hundred yards and you'll have a hard time telling the two apart. Where it shows up is around the green, where you're judging distance by feel instead of by a number, and a club that tells you the truth is worth having.

If you never chip and you've made peace with every bunker, the cast one's fine. If half your round happens inside a hundred yards, like it does for most of us, feel isn't a nice extra. It's the whole job.

SO WHY DOES FORGED USUALLY COST MORE?

Partly the process. Mostly the brands charging for it, who also pay for tour contracts, retail shelf space and a marketing department. The steel doesn't know about any of that. Ours is 1020 forged carbon steel with CNC-milled grooves, sold direct for $99.

CARVER 02 GOLD

1020 forged carbon steel, six lofts, sixty days to send it back.

SEE IT

HOW TO TELL WHAT YOU ALREADY OWN

- Look for the word forged stamped on the head. Brands that forge say so, because it costs them more.
- Check the spec sheet. Carbon steel in the 1020 or 1025 range is usually forged, and 431 or 17-4 stainless is almost always cast.

None of that makes a cast wedge a bad club. It makes it a different one, at a price that should reflect it, and often doesn't.

QUICK ANSWERS

Are Lucky wedges forged? –

Yes. Every Carver, gold or black, is 1020 forged carbon steel.

Will a forged wedge help on full swings? –

Not much. The difference shows up on touch shots around the green, where feel decides the distance.

How do I know if my wedge is forged? –

Look for forged on the head, or check the spec sheet for carbon steel in the 1020 to 1025 range.

KEEP READING

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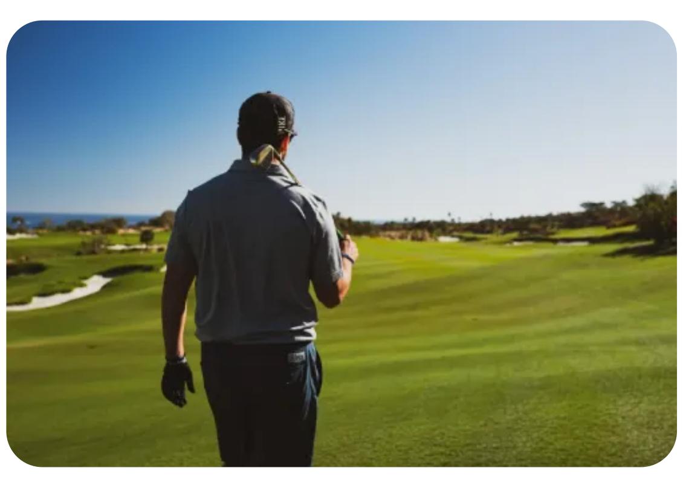

GOLF IS A MENTAL GAME

WHY GOLF WEDGES ARE THE MOST IMPORTANT CLUB IN YOUR BAG

GOLF.COM PROVES WHY A LUCKY CHARM IS NECESSARY ON THE COURSE

THE LAST WORD

FORGED, NOT CAST

Every Carver is forged, and you get sixty days to find out if you can feel the difference.

SEE THE CARVER

FIRST LOOK

New lofts, restocks and the odd bad idea, straight to your inbox.

you@somewhere.com   SIGN ME UP

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It's better to be lucky.